

2014-15 Review Process

Manager Review

Jonathan Daniel Micklos

Performance Review: 04/01/2014 - 03/31/2015

Reviewer: Kevin Maher

Role: Manager

Status: Completed

Manager: Kevin Maher

Overall Performance Summary

Employee Summary:

Much like the previous year, this year has presented great opportunities for the growth of my skillset. Previously, at the very start of 2013, I had transitioned from Software Development Engineer (SDE) to Technical Program manager (TPM). In April of 2014, I was presented the opportunity to transition to Software Development Manager (SDM). This being one of my long-term career aspirations post TPM, and being that I had felt I had acquired my personally requisite TPM experience prior to becoming an SDM, I took the opportunity.

As TPM, my primary 2014 goal was to TPM the launch of the Fire tv Sizzle Site. Fire tv Sizzle Site successfully launched in April 2014. As SDM, my accomplishments for 2014 have included ramping up three new SDEs and two new Website Development Engineers (WDE); readying one of the WDEs for promotion; launching various go-to-market (GTM) and support projects for new Amazon Digital Devices; migrating the first phase of US Device ASINs to Universal Detail Page (UDP); readying our categories and team for mobile development through the launch of Mobile Family Stripe; supporting upsell programs for Kindle Unlimited and Prime; supporting teams such as Kindle Content Platform (KCP) on services such as Kindle Letter Service (KLS); reducing cost of launch through projects like Build-Time-Config deprecation; and otherwise increase operational excellence. Through these experiences I believe that my performance over the course of the year shows that I am on path to demonstrate I am passing the bar as SDM II, as well as am currently demonstrating executing some of the responsibility of an SDM III.

The final project I had delivered as TPM was the launch of the Fire tv Sizzle Site. For this, I managed and reported on the development tasks/schedule and beta program. Launching Fire tv Sizzle Site took significant work from the dev team and TPM as it was the first Sizzle Site that our team had launched. For the beta program I managed a list of amazonians – providing them access to the sizzle site for and soliciting feedback from them. For the tracking of the tasks and schedule, I broke down the various external dependencies launching the new HTML rendering service would require. So in addition to tracking the development schedule from our team, I accounted for, and drove the completion of support for things such as SEO, paid search, alarming, DoS mitigation, failover strategy, hosting, performance and business metrics, and fatals generation and capture. In addition to these components, I drove signoff for the product from Dev, QA, PM, and Legal. Overall, the Fire tv Sizzle Site launched on time and was thorough enough to even garner comments such as “Thx Jon, very thorough. Love that you even track Discovery elements” from Ken Price.

Fire tv was announced on April 2nd, 2014. Immediately following which, I began taking on the duties as SDM – officially switching title to SDM II on April 29th, 2014. My team is the ODS-Store team. It initially began with three developers: Lin Yang (SDE I), Marjorie Volk (SDE I), and Devon Brinks

(WDE I). Over the course of the year the team's personnel changed. Lin Yang left Amazon at the end of the summer, following her boyfriend's relocation to California for a new job. Marjorie switched from the ODS-Store Team to the ODS-Installments Team – and ultimately quit after not being able to hit a stride as an SDE I at Amazon on either team. Starting with the addition of Shweta Sinha at the end of April, the team has grown to include eight members: Devon Brinks (WDE I), Shweta Sinha (WDE I), Pooja Sharma (QAE I), Chris Szurgot (QAE II), Brock Allen (SDE I), Sebastian Pierce-Durance (SDE I), and Max Erler (SDE I) and Adrian Chow (SDE II). For a brief time, Sudhamsu Mylavarapu was also a member.

Starting in reverse order, Sudhamsu joined the company in 2013. He was briefly a member of ODS-Store in the summer of 2014. However, Sudhamsu's interest in focusing on supporting new-generation device launches proved invaluable. Sudhamsu ended up taking on the position as lead for support generational launches. His on-going support is invaluable in separating the launch team activities (Sudhamsu's team) from feature development (ODS-Store team) and allowing for feature development to occur.

Adrian joined KiSIT (the name of the team prior to ODS) around the same time I had – in August of 2011. He was promoted to SDE II under Joe Papa in the Spring of 2014. He then joined the ODS-Store team in October of 2014. He has joined the team as our Subject Matter Expert (SME) for our non-retail-website services. As a part of his development, and the development of others, he has unofficially mentored Lin Yang during the Prime Promo launch. I have also asked him to unofficially mentor Max Erler during his current work to support Oft and Doppler invites. The intent is that during 2015 they will work together on the effort to launch self-service for DAMS, and ODS-Metadata Store, and then re-write our welcome e-mail (KLS) and promotion platforms (Peter Pan). Additionally, I have encouraged Adrian to impart knowledge about our team's services (such as DAMS) through brown bags to the rest of the team. This request to Adrian and it's output to the team have both been well received.

Max joined the team directly from college in late October 2014. Previously interning at Amazon, Max has hit the ground running. His main project thus far has been to reduce the cost of launch and maintenance by deprecating our Item Recommendation Service. This service was responsible for recommending what ASIN/Marketplace a customer should visit in the event that they were unable to ship another given ASIN to a given country. For Gen-7 device launch, support from this service was explicitly excluded for all Gen-7 devices due to its overall cost to support and perceived minimal value. Instead all Gen-7 customers would be redirected to a gateway for the marketplace that services their country. Use of this service has now ceased and Max will be turning it off in February 2015. Max has additionally helped in launching UDP for Desktop. He is responsible for implementing the Jump-Links widget for UDP. As mentioned, I will be shifting his focus in 2015 to work on our team's services.

Sebastian joined the team directly from college in September 2014. His focus has been on the migration of the country picker widget to UDP. This is the widget which allows customers to select what country they wish to ship a Rest-Of-World (ROW) Device to. The widget then updates what ASIN to show in cart. To accomplish this, he has work with our Product Manager Jen Walsh and Designer Asia Vanderbilt on the CX, and various dependent teams for the services we rely on. This has included our reverse logistics teams, the Jurisdiction Service team, and the Content Platform team. I have been coaching him on the proper amount of persistence to approach such contact – and he succeeded in taking a widget which was previously nearly entirely configured through campaign arguments in Amabot and turned it into one which is nearly 100% data driven. This greatly reduces the overall cost for site merchandisers to maintain our ROW device pages. For what remains (mapping countries to ASINs automatically), Max has written a list of options on how to automate. We intend to proceed with one of the options from the plan in 2015.

Brock joined in July of 2014. Brock was hired to fill the mobile development headcount for our team. I have had him focus on readying our device categories for mobile development by our team, ramping up the rest of our team on mobile development and delivering the first mobile widget for our product

detail pages – the mobile family stripe. Brock delivered the mobile family stripe at the end of 2014. In addition to which, Brock has helped with device-launch support for Amazon Echo – building out the mobile app experience and implementing a completely real-time configurable (configuration in G2S2) system for gating, redirecting, and otherwise responding to requests to our product detail pages across desktop browser and all UDP enabled clients. This will reduce the cost of generational and completely-new product launches by providing a common framework for gating and redirecting traffic. I have also asked Brock to take on the responsibility of managing our team's developer virtual machines. For our developer virts he is responsible for maintaining the fleet pools and has distributed documentation on how best to setup "borrowed" and "developer-assigned" hardware.

Brock has presented one area for growth for me during the year – giving timely constructive feedback. During the launch of Amazon Echo, Brock had relied on testing for mobile apps on an in-browser emulator. While approved by RCX, the emulator failed to fully emulate the app experience for all platforms – requiring post launch clean-up for some phone apps. While I had mentioned to Brock that we shouldn't just test with the emulator (it can't be trusted – nearly by definition), I should have been more clear and directed him to figuring out how to do the testing on mobile devices directly. Subsequently, during the initial launch of the mobile family stripe – it was noticed that the family stripe was not rendering on mobile apps (despite rendering on the emulator). The same mistake had occurred – should I have been more clear the first time, this may not have happened. Additionally, after reporting the incident to Joe, it was clear to me that I had not been clear enough with Brock even the second time. After which, I met with Brock and Pooja to discuss what we need to do different going forward and explained to them that this sort of mistake is not acceptable. Going forward, I do not have great concern that this will be an issue as I feel this is more a matter of knowing how clearly I need to communicate, rather than something bore out of being timid or not willing to give constructive feedback to my team.

Chris joined in December 2014. As this is one month, I will keep this section short. Previously working at Microsoft for 6 years – he is the QA mobile lead and is building out our mobile testing automation platform.

Pooja has been with Amazon since June 2013. She joined the ODS-Store team in October 2014. Since (and before) joining, she has been truly invaluable to the team. Through the year, there was a reorg of QA for ODS in general. Pooja stayed through this (while others have left) and has shown through as a leader – taking up the mantle to now manage the project to launch our test automation and pipelines for UDP and general retail website. More importantly, she has been the QA leader on ODS for organizing QA resources and duties (e.g. arranging the QA on-call rotation).

Shweta joined Amazon as an industry hire in late April 2014. Initially, Shweta spent some of her time supporting Gen-7 launch with some work on the image. However, far more importantly, she has been our main developer for both the launch of Amazon Echo and Oft (official name is TBD). Her ability to deliver the product page and much of the invite flow for Amazon Echo on time and with a high quality bar is a large reason why I was originally considering putting her up for promotion in the Fall of 2014. However, after receiving feedback which pointed to her needing to work on "develop the best," I held off. As a Web Dev II, my expectation would be that she plays a far more important role in guiding the team on web-development trends and best practices. I am currently coaching her on this and finding opportunities where she can have an even stronger case for promotion Fall 2015.

Devon also joined Amazon as an industry hire – joining in March 2014. Much like Shweta, Devon has shown development/execution skills of a Web Dev II. Devon has successfully delivered the first stage of our UDP project in the US (dialling up all non-family stripe ASINs on UDP). However, in contrast, Devon has led the team itself on front-end development. Examples of this range from helping others with their front end development (e.g. Devon took over the rendering of Mobile Family Stripe from Brock in order to help launch on time) to giving the team brown bag presentation on proper JavaScript OO best practice. Also, by example, Devon took it upon himself to analyse the latency of the page and request time to refactor the Desktop Family Stripe – which ultimately

reduced latency for clickToATF by ~800ms at tp50 and ~1.75s at tp90 and resulted in an increase of OPS by 0.88% for USAmazon. I have also asked Devon to take on some of the operational roles of the team. During 2014, Devon has acted as Scrum Master, and CTI/TT/Weblab master (e.g. driving down our TTs, reporting to me ongoing active issues on a weekly basis, helping to drive down outstanding weblab TTs from 57 at the start of November 2014 to 35 mid January 2015, and working with me to manage our CTIs). These are among other reasons that I have put him up for promotion in Spring 2015 – the promotion has so far been approved in our local OLR and is pending approval from upper management.

Marjorie Volk joined Amazon in 2013. One of the main projects I worked on with her was the launch of the Fire phone product detail page. This was a relatively complicated project that saw launch day problems. The requirements for the detail page were to utilize the buying functionality from Amazon Wireless, but still have the merchandiseability of our existing product pages. Unfortunately, Amazon Wireless runs on Santana, and does not have support for amabot. To get around this, Marjorie and I worked on a technical design whereby our gurupa mason pages would make a call to Santana, retrieve a serialized mapping of the HTML for the widgets that we required, and then directly include them on the page. We reviewed this approach in a high level technical design with Brian Tajuddin from Website/Content Platform. During this time, I had to rely on pair-programming with Marjorie as she was unable/not motivated enough to get the work done herself. There were a handful of weekends that we came in to finish development on time. We delivered on time and QA testing did not find any bugs major.

However, it is important to mention the events during our launch. Our implementation relied on re-passing the received cookies from the reverse proxy as a part of the headers to Santana. Due in part to the fact that the weblab overrides for testing are passed in via cookie, testing masked a bug in the processing and forwarding of the cookies. Independent of this, the cookie forwarding proved suboptimal – instead working with the Santana/Wireless teams to pass credentials via the Santana API would have been preferred. Unfortunately, many days of searching through the Wireless, Santana, and Gurupa Mason teams (directly, and through documentation) did not provide the information we needed and the cookie option was used. Upon launch, the cookie bug was expressed and XX% of Fire phone customers were unable to add to cart. Immediately after dialup, the ODS and Wireless teams rallied on a solution. I helped to orchestrate the necessary deployments with the DPX/BX teams to limit the bad CX rate of expression. After which, we brought overall customer impact close to 0% impact.

Lin Yang also joined Amazon in 2013. I also worked with Lin to support the Launch of Fire phone – specifically adding support for Prime Promo into Peter Pan. On the side of Product Manager, I worked with Jon Lim on the project. The request for this project came very late into build out of support fore Fire phone as a Jeff Bezos mandate that we would include Prime as a promotion for the device. The cost for which was 56 developer weeks from the prime team and what resulted in 9 weeks of total dev effort from our team. Our team rallied to get the project done. This meant that we were actively developing, discovering use cases, and adjusting our plan proactively nearly the entire time. The project was initially scoped by Adrian to take around three weeks of developer time. However, this was dependent upon known use cases. Our development approach was to first support Prime Promo for online-sold devices, and then once dev-complete and more information was known about AT&T reverse logistics – to build support for offline-sold devices. As reverse-logistics complications for offline were bottomed out with AT&T we added support for the use cases. Lin was the only developer on this project on ODS, implementing an amorphous set of requirements for a Jeff Bezos last minute mandate – we delivered under high pressure and it was launched on time, without customer impacting bugs, despite high adversity.

However, I would like to make some callouts as learnings. Lin was an SDE fresh out of college, and she was placed on a limited-time very-high-visibility and very-high-complexity project. The later we did not know until well into the project. Ultimately, our collective tenacity (especially Lin's) saw the project to production. Lin spent a solid month's worth of weekends working on the project in order to meet the deadline – for some of which I would meet her to assist with unblocking testing from other

teams. Additionally, the implementation has on-going operational cost. In order to support reverse logistics for AT&T, we receive a CSV of IMEIs for returned devices on a weekly basis. We then run this CSV through a script to remove Prime Promo for the customers with the devices the IMEIs belong to. I felt this a reasonable cost to absorb while the promotion completed in order to get us out the door on time.

Under a situation where more time was an option, I would have chosen (and have subsequently chosen this path for projects since) to have our team fully scope the entirety of the project prior to beginning work (not possible as the plan from AT&T was simultaneously still on-going). Then realizing that prime promo needed additional assistance, I would have escalated to either adjust the project or get additional SDE resources and likely swap out the project lead. However, in other situations, this has been demonstrated. As an example, I added Devon to the Mobile Family Stripe to get it to production on time (by the end of 2014) and have gotten Brock's help for launching Amazon Echo. Ultimately, "our team does not perform magic, it performs good engineering." However, considering the circumstances – the timeline mandates, the partner company, the limited resources – we rallied delivered in the face of adversity.

Overall, development and on-boarding of new employees has been a strength. Most of my directs have mentors and the rate at which Devon, Shweta, Brock, Max, and Sebastian have ramped up have been fundamental to the success of Amazon echo, UDP and mobile family stripe. To accomplish this, I have asked the developers to mentor one another directly, as well as share knowledge through brown bags and documentation.

Hiring has been one area where I still need to get better at. I have one SDE II headcount open that I need to fill. I have been proactively meeting with potential candidates who may be interested and reaching out to friend in recruiting. However, I have yet to fill the position. I intend to do so soon and will be focusing more time toward recruiting in 2015.

While not particularly necessary for the context of a yearly review, I feel compelled to explain that leading this team has been far and away the most gratifying thing I have ever done in my career. Prior to joining the workforce, I had thoroughly enjoyed mentoring and leading underclassmen as President of the ACM at Purdue. I have rekindled a part of me which had gone missing for nearly 6 years since graduating in 2008.

In addition to the above work with my directs, we have worked with partner teams to help them achieve their ends. Great examples where this has happened this year include the launch of the Kindle Unlimited Up-sell and Prime Up-sell in the buy box, and continued support of Kindle Content Platform's welcome letters in KLS. Throughout each of those examples, there was an ask for our team to directly support new business use cases and do the development work ourselves. And in each instance, we worked with the partner teams to get them to ultimately own finding other resources apart from our team, whereby we would offer consultation and code reviews on integration into our code.

During my time as SDM, I have been working on the following points to ensure I am hitting/surpass the bar as SDM II:

"You delegate appropriately and are adept at accomplishing team objectives through others." In this, I believe I have been demonstrating this more and more as time goes on. As examples, Shweta is owning the entire development backlog for Oft and Sebastian has been able to seek out answers (nearly on his own) for the Country Picker on UDP from other teams.

"You are increasingly independent in decision-making, but continue to keep your management informed of impactful changes."

This has been fundamentally necessary due to the number of variables involved in launching UDP. Without which, we would not be on track to launch all US ASINs in Q1 2015.

"You have participated in projects that involve multiple teams within your org and that may expand outside your normal area of responsibility or expertise."

Great examples of this include working with Prime for Prime Promo, Wireless for Fire phone launch, Kindle Unlimited and Prime for upsell, and KCP for reading-app welcome letters.

"You have gained experience with Amazon's annual performance review cycle. You have participated in multiple aspects of the employee lifecycle including hiring, goal setting, performance management, promotions, and retention."

This is one area in which I will only be able to fully demonstrate with time. This is the first review cycle I have been through (this current one) as SDM. However, the promo doc I wrote has been approved by my management chain all the way through my director. However, as mentioned, it is still pending final approval.

"You recognize who the high and low performers are and how to coach for performance at both ends of the spectrum. You provide timely and meaningful feedback."

As mentioned, while I can identify the high and low performers, and provide general feedback – timely feedback is something I have been working on this year and believe to no longer be an issue.

"You have developed expertise in your team's technical or business area and you understand how your team contributes to the success of your department."

I believe this is one of my stronger skills as a technical manager at Amazon.

"You have started to contribute to the technical vision for your department."

I was doing this through my contribution as SDE and TPM. I am doing this through the direction of UDP launch and will continue to do so in the coming year through invite platform, self serve services, upper funnel customer CX (family/device pages), and refactoring of our Welcome Letter and Promotions services.

"Peers, direct reports, customers and management recognize your contributions."

I believe this to be the case. The work I have had has been very public.

For the SDM III bar I believe I am beginning to show many of the traits, and intend to grow the depth for which I do in the coming year. Here is where I believe I am currently:

"You have shown the capacity to create the identity and structure for your team."

I am speaking to the allocation of resources on my team during QBR and working with those constraints with my manager and PMs to find working solutions for our orgs priorities. However, I want to work on overall vision for the team and be less reactive in this regard.

"You have participated in cross-functional projects working with teams across the company to achieve your goals."

I believe I have been doing this as explained above for SDM II.

"Your knowledge of your area is deep and people within your wider organization have begun to seek you out as a thought leader and functional expert."

As an example of where this is happening, this has been fundamentally necessary for the agreement on a minimal-viable-plan for Oft.

"You define metrics that can be used to measure your team's progress."

This is one area which is of main focus for me and was not demonstrated very clearly in 2014. I am happy for the opportunity that I currently have to do so.

"You are gaining a deeper understanding of Amazon's planning processes and may begin providing input to your management chain during the OP process."

This is another example of where time will provide experience. I have not yet had an opportunity to get involved with the OP process.

"You work closely with your management to understand broader organizational and corporate metrics and goals, and are more adept at aligning your team and its decisions with those goals." With regard to metric based goals – as stated above, this is something that I now have an opportunity to demonstrate. With regard to other goals, we have been doing this for device launches, UDP launch, and mobile.

"You have demonstrated competency in project planning and project delivery through multiple lifecycles."

I have demonstrated project planning for starting new projects/services. However, I would like more experience to demonstrate a greater degree of autonomy. Additionally, this coming year, I am looking forward to demonstrating executing projects that deal with refactoring existing services (KLS/Peter Pan refactoring).

"You have shown good judgement in hiring and performance management, demonstrating the ability to be independently responsible for these activities."

As mentioned above, demonstrating an ability to hire is one area which I am actively working on.

Manager Summary:

This past year has been a transitional year for Jon. Jon moved from the TPM role to SDM. In his role as TPM Jon was struggling somewhat. He had a hard time finding his footing trying to drive the UDP project (which was set as a goal for him by his previous manager.) Jon also was showing signs of frustration dealing with launch support (including some less than ideal interactions with the launch TPM team.) It was clear that the main skills of a TPM – communication, organizational skills, etc... were not Jon's main strengths. He was a sprinter in a world of distance runners – the slow steady progress and process focus of a TPM were at odds with Jon's natural problem-solution orientation, technical skills and bias-for-action. Moving into an SDM role better aligned Jon with his strengths as a leader – tech depth, invent & simplify and dive deep are all areas that Jon does well.

As is often the case with someone new to people-management, it took a while for Jon to understand the right balances between doing the work and delegating the work, between setting the vision and between focusing on immediate needs. In the latter half of the year, Jon stabilized and is now hitting his stride as a people manager and tech leader. He has built a tremendous amount of trust with his direct reports. He has learned to think systematically and put mechanisms in place to ensure quality and consistency. Examples, include his progress in eliminating tech debt, progress in rolling out UDP (a plan which had many moving parts and external dependencies) and his progress in developing the team – Jon was able to get Devon promoted in under a year, and has helped Shweta become a top-tier performer as well. His team has a great deal of respect for each other and for Jon – he's built a highly collaborative group.

This year Jon's primary goal has been to deliver all Kindle ASINs on UDP. Jon worked with internal and external stakeholders (RCX team, ODS product management and site merchandisers, amongst others) to build a plan to migrate from oldest to newest ASINs. This was a delicate transition that had to be worked in alongside other tactical work including – bootstrapping mobile development efforts, mobile family stripe, Echo launch, Gen7 Tablet and eInk launch. Jon was able to manage the technical details of this effort as well as properly manage "up" (including interacting directly with Neil Lindsay on numerous occasions.) Jon has made great progress this year and is emerging as a thoughtful and effective technical leader.

Identify Strengths

Employee Summary:

Deliver Results: I hope that considering the breadth of things delivered this year this speaks for itself. We stood up to take on Prime Promo and Fire phone launch and we've executed on UDP and Mobile family stripe.

Bias For Action: Bias for action has always been one of my major strengths. Examples in which I have demonstrated this have included the ability to get Prime Promo and Fire phone detail page launched on time. Another great example is our incremental approach to launch UDP on Desktop and Mobile Family Stripe - always have something to launch.

Hire and Develop the Best: While I have yet to hire anyone directly (actively working on it), I have been through 73 previous interview loops while at Amazon. With regard to developing the best, Devon is on track to promotion in the spring of 2015, I'm working with Shweta for Fall 2015, and I have been coaching the others on my team to work through their mentors and each other to ramp quickly and deliver quality results on UDP and Mobile Development.

Vocally Self Critical: I intend to grow in skill set in my career quickly. To do so requires constant introspection and evaluation of recent performance.

Manager Summary:

1. Invent and Simplify. Jon was a valued SDE II on the team before transitioning to leadership. He often leverages his breadth of system knowledge to propose solutions that simplify. A good example of this is during Gen7 launch, Jon helped steer the development team toward a twistable image block solution that leveraged an existing twister extension mechanism. This greatly simplified the ability to support "stretchy goodness" on the page and unblocked the launch as a result.

2. Ownership. Jon is so heavily biased toward ownership that it ends up being a double-edged sword. He really has to work at knowing when to say no to work that is either outside his charter or not a priority. A good example of his ownership is the detail page "lifecycle" project. Jon took this idea and, when the PM associated left, continued to own and drive the plan and execution.

3. Earns Trust of Others. Jon has established a great deal of technical credibility with his direct reports and his unassuming, open communication style has also endeared him to his team.

Identify Areas for Improvement

Employee Summary:

I believe that during this year, my biggest area for improvement is "earn trust of others." As an SDE (and even as a TPM), I made a name for myself with regard to the quality I would be able to produce, while on time, and while being able to add additional features/functionality outside of the scope of the MVP. Having a high bar for this is incredibly important to me. As an SDM, I fell short of this when Fire phone launched in July (on time) with launch-day bugs. Demonstrating recovery from this has been one of the top priorities I've had as manager. I believe we have been showing this quality in UDP and our approach to Oft, and will continue to do so.

Hiring: As mentioned in "Hire and Develop the Best" I need to work on the hiring portion of Hire and Develop the Best. I am actively working on this and have next steps setup to continue to meet with interested candidates for the open SDE II rec I have.

Manager Summary:

1. Earns Trust of Others. While Jon has done a great job of building trust with his team, he has some frayed relationships with both PM and TPMs that work with the team. The root of these issues is

Jon's overzealous ownership. Jon overpromised and under delivered on a few occasions including a miscommunication about the state of mobile support for Gen7 and, most recently, by permitting resourcing plan for Oft to be promulgated as committed when in fact it was not. Jon's Vocally Self-Critical nature has let him recover, but ensuring consistency in word and deed will go a long way to improving Jon's effectiveness as a leader.

2. Hire and Develop the Best. Jon has not yet established a working relationship with recruiting and nor does he have any mechanisms to cultivate a pipeline of talent. Jon has made no hires and only had very limited participation in the hiring process. He's done well developing the talent he has inherited, but he will need to really invest in cultivating his talent pipeline to succeed long-term as an SDM.

3. Insist on the Highest Standards. Jon "cut his teeth" in an environment that was scrappy and put time-to-market concerns above all else. Jon has done well in this environment. However, there have been occasions – for example Fire Phone launch – where Jon was "swept up" in the tactical rush and instead should have been more of a proponent for quality. Striking this balance – driving quality, while delivering results – is a key contradiction Jon will need to learn to balance to ensure his growth as a leader.

Ratings

Performance Rating: Exceeds

Leadership Principles Rating: Solid Strength